



Hibernate – Mock Interview Questions

1. What is Hibernate? Why do we use it?

Cross Q1: How is Hibernate better than JDBC?

Cross Q2: Can you name any alternatives to Hibernate?

2. What is ORM (Object-Relational Mapping)?

Cross Q1: How does ORM help avoid boilerplate code?

Cross Q2: What are the disadvantages of ORM?

3. What are the main advantages of using Hibernate?

Cross Q1: How does Hibernate improve database portability?

Cross Q2: What is transparent persistence?

4. What are the core interfaces of Hibernate?

Cross Q1: What is the role of SessionFactory?

Cross Q2: Is Session thread-safe?

5. What is a Hibernate configuration file?

Cross Q1: What are the two types of configuration methods in Hibernate?

Cross Q2: What is the difference between hibernate.cfg.xml and hibernate.properties?

6. What is a Hibernate mapping file?

Cross Q1: What is the purpose of hbm.xml?

Cross Q2: Can we use annotations instead of mapping XML?

7. How do you define entity classes in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: What annotation is used to mark a class as an entity?



Cross Q2: Can an entity class be abstract?

8. How do you map a primary key using annotations?

Cross Q1: What is the use of `@Id` and `@GeneratedValue`?

Cross Q2: What are the different generation strategies in Hibernate?

9. What are the different types of Hibernate inheritance mappings?

Cross Q1: Which strategy is best in terms of performance?

Cross Q2: How is `@Inheritance(strategy = InheritanceType.JOINED)` used?

10. What are the different types of relationships in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: Difference between `@OneToMany` and `@ManyToOne`?

Cross Q2: What happens when cascade is enabled?

11. What is the difference between `get()` and `load()` method?

Cross Q1: Which one uses lazy loading?

Cross Q2: What happens if the record does not exist?

12. What is the difference between `save()` and `persist()`?

Cross Q1: Which one returns a primary key?

Cross Q2: Which one is part of the JPA specification?

13. What is lazy loading in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: How do you disable lazy loading?

Cross Q2: What is a `LazyInitializationException`?

14. What is the difference between `merge()` and `update()`?

Cross Q1: When should you use `merge()` instead of `update()`?



Cross Q2: What happens if the entity is already associated with a session?

15. What is HQL (Hibernate Query Language)?

Cross Q1: How is HQL different from SQL?

Cross Q2: Can HQL be used for join operations?

16. What is the difference between HQL and Criteria API?

Cross Q1: Which one is more suitable for dynamic query building?

Cross Q2: Is Criteria API deprecated in Hibernate 5 and replaced with JPA Criteria?

17. What are named queries in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: Where can you define named queries?

Cross Q2: What are the benefits of using named queries?

18. What is transaction management in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: What is the role of Transaction interface?

Cross Q2: Can you manage transactions without using Hibernate Transaction API?

19. What is the first-level cache in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: Is the first-level cache session-specific?

Cross Q2: How can you clear it manually?

20. What is the second-level cache in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: What are popular providers for 2nd level cache?

Cross Q2: How is it configured?

21. What is the difference between detached and persistent objects?

Cross Q1: How do you reattach a detached object?



Cross Q2: What operations are allowed on detached objects?

22. What is cascading in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: What are different cascade types?

Cross Q2: When is CascadeType.ALL risky?

23. What are the fetching strategies in Hibernate?

Cross Q1: What is the default fetching type for @OneToMany?

Cross Q2: Difference between FetchType.EAGER and FetchType.LAZY?

24. What is the role of the @JoinColumn annotation?

Cross Q1: How is it used in @ManyToOne or @OneToOne?

Cross Q2: Can you use composite foreign keys with it?

25. What are common performance issues in Hibernate and how do you resolve them?

Cross Q1: What is the N+1 select problem?

Cross Q2: How does fetch join help in solving it?
